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Posted on Dec 6, 2025

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WARNING TO DEVELOPERS: A new wave of “technical test scams” is targeting devs

#development #scam #recruiting

🚨 WARNING TO DEVELOPERS: A new wave of “technical test scams” is targeting devs — and it's getting more sophisticated

Over the past few months, several developers — including myself — have been targeted by a scam involving fake technical tests sent by “recruiters.”
People like **Allan Lancioni**, **João Pessoa**, and **Muhammad Ramadhani** have already documented identical attacks. Their posts are MUST-read.

This is not theoretical.
It’s real. It’s happening now.
And yes — it *almost* happened to me this year.

🔥 How the scam works (same pattern every time):

1. A “recruiter” (sometimes pretending to be a CEO/HR) contacts you.
2. The job looks amazing — above-market salary, remote position, paid in USD, etc.
3. They ask for your CV and GitHub.
4. They say you’re “approved for the next stage” without any real interview.
5. Before the call, they send you a **codebase to review or modify** as a “technical test.”

And that’s where the attack kicks in.

Running the project executes a malicious script hidden inside the dependencies, allowing remote code execution and giving the attacker access to your machine — especially to browser wallets and local credentials.

🧨 Real cases from the community

👉 Allan Lancioni

He reverse-engineered an actual attack.
The project contained scripts that enabled code injection and crypto-wallet theft.
His post (highly recommended):
https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/como-identifiquei-um-golpe-em-teste-t%C3%A9cnico-an%C3%A1lise-real-lancioni-kcyac/

👉 João Pessoa

He received a suspicious repo as a “technical test.”
In the package.json he found:

- `fs@0.0.1-security` (placeholder inserted when a malicious package is removed)
- `execp@0.0.1` (malicious package designed to execute arbitrary commands)
- `request` (deprecated + vulnerable)
- A remote-code-execution script hidden in `dark.min.js` using `atob + eval`

His post:
https://www.linkedin.com/in/jppessoa/

👉 Muhammad Ramadhani

Received an almost identical project with the same malicious dependencies.
His warning went viral in the Web3 community.

Profile: https://www.linkedin.com/in/ramadhvni/

⚠️ And my personal case?

Yes — **they tried this with me too**.

The red flags:

- The company claimed to be “X”, but the recruiter used a **gmail.com** address.
- The repo had *zero* relation to the company name.
- The project involved crypto (again, same pattern).
- The code structure was suspicious.
- They pushed me to run the project before any technical call.

The repo I received:
👉 `mega-org99/Coinpromoting_dApp`

Allan even replied saying the repo he received was extremely similar:
👉 `megaorg991/tokentradingdapp`

Same structure.
Same dependencies.
Same modus operandi.
Probably the **same group**.

My intuition kicked in — and I **dropped the process immediately**.
Better to lose a “job opportunity” than compromise my machine, accounts, and data.

🛡️ How to protect yourself (practical checklist):

✔ 1. NEVER run `npm install`, `yarn`, or `pip install` on unknown projects.

Open the dependency files first.
Look for suspicious packages, single-version modules, weird names, etc.

✔ 2. Be skeptical of any test sent *before* a real conversation.

Scammers skip interviews — they push codebases.

✔ 3. **Check the recruiter’s email and company domain.

Gmail = Red Flag.**

✔ 4. Ask for a technical explanation of the project.

Scammers avoid calls.

✔ 5. Use ChatGPT to analyze suspicious code.

Paste dependencies → it will flag malicious patterns instantly.

✔ 6. If an offer seems too good to be true… it probably is.

High salary + “easy test” + no interview = scam formula.

🚨 Final reminder: This isn’t paranoia — it’s protection.

Scammers target developers because:

- devs run code
- devs store SSH keys, API tokens, environment secrets
- devs often have corporate access
- devs trust “technical tests” too easily
- devs working with Web3/crypto are especially vulnerable

If something feels off, **walk away**.
Your instinct is a security tool.

Stay safe. Audit everything. Trust nothing blindly.

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